

installed.

- Walk out of the building in a calm and composed manner to the given location through the given route.
- Do not run, it will cause panic among others.
- Do not use elevators/lifts or conveyors.
- Follow the instructions of the guide.
- Do not argue or talk with the guide. It will waste time and obstruct evacuation.
- Carry personal valuables, but do not stop to wind up work.
- Supervisors may need to switch off the machinery and power supply in their respective areas.
- Open all windows, doors and cupboards.
- Do not obstruct passage of search and rescue squad.
- Wait in the assembly area till further instructions.
- Do not spread rumours or speculate and cause panic.

The supervisor must take attendance in the

Actions on receipt of a bomb threat call

- Stay calm and listen carefully. Signal others around you to stay quiet and if possible pick up extension phones to listen in.
- Write down the number displayed on the caller ID display of your telephone.
- Get maximum information and prolong calls as far as possible. Pretend you did not hear correctly, ask the caller to repeat. Ask questions—location of the bomb, time to explode, what type of bomb, how can we get rid of it, who has placed the bomb, from where are you calling, what is your name, reason for placing the bomb—in that exact order.
- Try to identify background noises such as traffic, music, conversation that may help to determine the location from where the call is being made.
- Make an educated guess on sex, age, race, voice (loud, soft, pleasant, intoxicated) or accent, speech (fast, slow, nasal, slurred) and manner (calm, emotional, vulgar, angry, laughing, righteous) which may help identify the caller. Be advised that the caller could also be in an agitated state.
- Alert a colleague; report the call to your manager or security manager immediately.
- Fill up the bomb threat call check list.
- A bomb threat could also be in the form of a mail/written message. Report these to the security manager.

And what if you are caught in a blast?

Given the nature of blasts, it is impossible to predict the exact situation you could be in. However, here are some generic guidelines that could be of help.

- Depending on your distance from the blast, you could be in various degrees of consciousness.
- The first effect of a blast is a numbing disorientation. Try to get your bearings. If you are in a prone position, stay down.
- Try to remain calm. If you are conscious and can move yourself, examine yourself for injuries. Blasts commonly cause concussion and lacerations. The former causes damage to organs and bones and the latter causes bleeding.
- Be aware that there could be secondary blasts.
- Do not panic and create stampedes.
- Do not search through debris.
- If you are capable of it, assist others until help arrives.

assembly area and if any employees/visitors are found missing, it must be investigated.

Make “Be Prepared” your motto

A bomb threat plan should be drawn up in every organisation and tested to assess the organisation's readiness and ability to respond. This should be part of the incident management plan. If there is a real bomb threat or any emergency that requires evacuation, such efforts will reduce the damage. The organisation, depending on its structure and nature of business, must draw out a model plan by assessing its risks, deciding on a policy and training personnel to implement it. The plan must be rehearsed and lessons learnt must be incorporated.

It is also advisable to carry out a threat assessment to prevent the organisation from being an easy target for potential bombers.

Telephone operators and PAs should be trained in questioning techniques for extracting maximum information from the caller. A “bomb threat check list” guidance should be available with them. Organisations should make arrangements for tracing and recording of incoming calls.

The organisation must train security officers, maintenance staff and others in carrying out search and evacuation. A suitable area should be earmarked as assembly area. ☐

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